Video 10 | Leads and Pads

Massive PSXL instructional series - video script

Runtime estimate	Narration length	Scenes	Format
about 4:29 minutes	628 words at 150 words per minute	12	Screen capture of the plug-in with voice-over; dark theme, interface size 125 percent

Learning goals

- Build a supersaw, an expressive mono lead, a string pad and a vowel pad.
- Add expression with mod wheel and aftertouch, and movement with slow LFOs.

NOTE. Accuracy rule for the narrator and any generated video: use the on-screen names exactly as written in the action column. After **Load Init (Blank)** the synth is silent until routing is connected. Do not compare Massive PSXL to other products.

Scene table

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
1	Load Init (Blank), quick setup Osc 1 > Filter 1 > Out; Osc 1 Morph Basic Pos 0.66, Unison 8, Detune 34.	Leads and pads are where unison shines. Init Blank, quick setup with one oscillator. A saw, eight unison voices, detune thirty-four. That is a supersaw. Eight voices can sound huge, but they also use a lot of processing, especially when you play chords. If your computer struggles, reduce the unison or the polyphony.	Short before/after: Unison 1 then 8.
2	Filter 1 Cutoff 7000 Reso 0.15; Amp Env Attack 0.006 Decay 0.3 Sustain 0.85 Release 0.35; Chor Mix 0.25; Verb Size 0.6 Mix 0.2.	Open the filter to seven thousand. Amp envelope: short attack, sustain point eight five, release a third of a second. Chorus a quarter. Reverb size point six, mix point two. A touch of chorus makes the supersaw wider, and the reverb places it in a space. Notice we leave the delay for the lead patch.	Play a chord progression.
3	New: Init (Blank), Osc 1 > Filter 1 > Out. Osc 1 Pos 0.66 Unison 3 Detune 14. Pitch panel: Voice Mode Mono, Glide 0.03. Filter Cutoff 5000 Reso 0.18.	Now a mono lead. Three unison voices, mono mode, a tiny glide. Cutoff five thousand. Mono mode plays one note at a time. Combined with a very short glide, it gives that smooth connection between notes that makes a lead feel like an instrument.	Play a monophonic line.
4	Drag ModWhl chip onto Osc 1 Pos (+0.4) and Filter 1 Cutoff (+0.25); AftTch onto Cutoff +0.15. Move the mod wheel on the on-screen keyboard.	Add expression. Drag the ModWhl chip onto Pos and onto Cutoff, and the AftTch chip onto Cutoff. Move the wheel and the sound morphs and opens. If your keyboard sends aftertouch, pressing harder brightens it. Everything here is an assignment you can edit. If the mod wheel changes too much, right-click the knob and lower the amount. A lead should feel responsive, not wild.	Show the keyboard wheel and the white dots on the knobs.
5	Mod 3: Type LFO, Sine, Rate 5.2 Hz, Fade In 0.6; chip onto Pitch panel Pitch knob; amount +0.003. Delay: Sync on, 1/8, Mix 0.2.	A delayed vibrato: Mod 3 as a sine LFO at five point two hertz with a fade in of point six seconds, onto the Pitch knob with a tiny amount. Then a synced eighth-note delay. The fade in is important. A vibrato that is present at the start of a note sounds mechanical, while one that arrives after a moment sounds like a singer or a violinist.	Show LFO display with Fade In.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
6	New: Init (Blank), Osc 1 > Filter 1 > Out. Osc 1 Pos 0.66 Unison 6 Detune 22. Filter Cutoff 2400 Reso 0.1. Amp Env Attack 0.8 Decay 0.6 Sustain 0.85 Release 1.6.	String pad. A saw with six voices detuned twenty-two cents. Cutoff twenty-four hundred. The amp envelope has an attack of point eight seconds and a release of one point six. A pad needs time. The long attack means notes swell in, and the long release means they overlap and blend into a continuous wash.	Show Amp Env graph.
7	Chor Mix 0.35; Verb Size 0.75 Mix 0.3. Drag M1 onto Filter 1 Cutoff and M2 onto Reverb Mix.	Chorus thirty-five percent, a big reverb. Now put cutoff and reverb mix on macros so you can play the pad's brightness and space. With the brightness and the space under your fingers, you can bring the pad from dark and distant to bright and close, which is often all a pad needs to fit into a track.	Show macro labels renaming.
8	New: Init (Blank), Osc 1 > Filter 1 > Out. Osc 1 wavetable Vowel Choir Pos 0.3 Unison 5 Detune 14. Mod 2 LFO Sine 0.2 Hz onto Osc 1 Pos +0.12; slow amp envelope; Verb Size 0.85 Mix 0.45.	Choir pad. Choose the Vowel Choir table, position point three, five unison voices. A slow LFO, point two hertz, on Pos, plus point one two, so the vowel drifts. Slow amp envelope and a very large reverb. The position knob also makes a great target for a macro. Dragging a macro onto Pos lets you move through vowels by hand.	Overlay A E I O U along the Pos axis.
9	Drag Pos manually from 0 to 1 on the held chord.	The vowels shift with the note you play, because they are baked into the wave shape. They sound most natural in the low to middle range. If you want a more natural voice, keep the pitch low, and use fewer unison voices, since more voices blur the vowel.	Callout of this tip.
10	Brass stab: Init, quick setup Osc 1 + Osc 2 > Filter 1 > Out; both Morph Basic Pos 0.66; Osc 1 Unison 4 Detune 12; Osc 2 Fine +6 Unison 2 Level 0.5; Cutoff 1200; Mod 2 Attack 0.04 Decay 0.3 Sustain 0.35 onto Cutoff +0.35.	Brass stab is two saws with a filter envelope that opens quickly: cutoff twelve hundred and Mod 2 on cutoff at plus point three five. Short amp envelope and a touch of reverb. For a longer swell like a film brass, increase the amp attack to a tenth of a second and give the filter envelope a slower attack and a bigger reverb.	Play a short chord stab.
11	Browse: Leads, Pads categories; click Super Stack, Expressive Lead, Warm Strings, Choir Dream.	Compare against the factory sounds: Super Stack, Expressive Lead, Warm Strings and Choir Dream. Looking at how the factory presets are built is one of the best ways to learn. Load one, open the tabs, and see which knobs have rings.	Highlight each preset name.
12	End card.	Leads and pads: unison, slow envelopes and a bit of motion. The last video covers presets, the keyboard, themes and wavetable import.	End card: 'Next: 11 Presets, keyboard, themes and import'.

Narration only (plain script for text-to-speech or NotebookLM)

[Scene 1] Leads and pads are where unison shines. Init Blank, quick setup with one oscillator. A saw, eight unison voices, detune thirty-four. That is a supersaw. Eight voices can sound huge, but they also use a lot of processing, especially when you play chords. If your computer struggles, reduce the unison or the polyphony.

[Scene 2] Open the filter to seven thousand. Amp envelope: short attack, sustain point eight five, release a third of a second. Chorus a quarter. Reverb size point six, mix point two. A touch of chorus makes the supersaw wider, and the reverb places it in a space. Notice we leave the delay for the lead patch.

[Scene 3] Now a mono lead. Three unison voices, mono mode, a tiny glide. Cutoff five thousand. Mono mode plays one note at a time. Combined with a very short glide, it gives that smooth connection between notes that makes a lead feel like an instrument.

[Scene 4] Add expression. Drag the ModWhl chip onto Pos and onto Cutoff, and the AftTch chip onto Cutoff. Move the wheel and the sound morphs and opens. If your keyboard sends aftertouch, pressing harder brightens it. Everything here is an assignment you can edit. If the mod wheel changes too much, right-click the knob and lower the amount. A lead should feel responsive, not wild.

[Scene 5] A delayed vibrato: Mod 3 as a sine LFO at five point two hertz with a fade in of point six seconds, onto the Pitch knob with a tiny amount. Then a synced eighth-note delay. The fade in is important. A vibrato that is present at the start of a note sounds mechanical, while one that arrives after a moment sounds like a singer or a violinist.

[Scene 6] String pad. A saw with six voices detuned twenty-two cents. Cutoff twenty-four hundred. The amp envelope has an attack of point eight seconds and a release of one point six. A pad needs time. The long attack means notes swell in, and the long release means they overlap and blend into a continuous wash.

[Scene 7] Chorus thirty-five percent, a big reverb. Now put cutoff and reverb mix on macros so you can play the pad's brightness and space. With the brightness and the space under your fingers, you can bring the pad from dark and distant to bright and close, which is often all a pad needs to fit into a track.

[Scene 8] Choir pad. Choose the Vowel Choir table, position point three, five unison voices. A slow LFO, point two hertz, on Pos, plus point one two, so the vowel drifts. Slow amp envelope and a very large reverb. The position knob also makes a great target for a macro. Dragging a macro onto Pos lets you move through vowels by hand.

[Scene 9] The vowels shift with the note you play, because they are baked into the wave shape. They sound most natural in the low to middle range. If you want a more natural voice, keep the pitch low, and use fewer unison voices, since more voices blur the vowel.

[Scene 10] Brass stab is two saws with a filter envelope that opens quickly: cutoff twelve hundred and Mod 2 on cutoff at plus point three five. Short amp envelope and a touch of reverb. For a longer swell like a film brass, increase the amp attack to a tenth of a second and give the filter envelope a slower attack and a bigger reverb.

[Scene 11] Compare against the factory sounds: Super Stack, Expressive Lead, Warm Strings and Choir Dream. Looking at how the factory presets are built is one of the best ways to learn. Load one, open the tabs, and see which knobs have rings.

[Scene 12] Leads and pads: unison, slow envelopes and a bit of motion. The last video covers presets, the keyboard, themes and wavetable import.

> **TIP.** Pause for about one second between scenes and let on-screen actions finish before the next sentence starts.